

install them. The user will get an additional drop-down menu for more interesting bit of controls and features.

Google Maps

Google Maps is a well designed, interactive and easy to use map service that allows you to find out where you are, get directions to any destination or find local hangouts and businesses, all there right in your hand while you are on the move. Here are a few tips on how to get the most out of this exiting and very useful feature on your phone:

Getting Directions

Google Maps does not give just directions, it actually allows you to choose your mode of traveling and then picks a route depending on whether you are in a vehicle or on foot. How brilliant does that sound! And in India, if you wish to use the Delhi Metro Rail, Kolkata Metro, Chennai MRTS or Bangalore Metropolitan Transport services, you can even choose the Public Transit option to get directions in surrounding areas to travel using the Metro too. Just go to Public Transit and put in your Start and End Point, and when you get directions for it, you'll see that it gives you details like the frequency of trains on

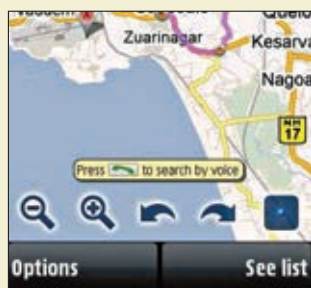


Now you can plan your trip on your cellphone

that route, where to change lines or tracks, expected time of travel, contact info for agencies and other useful information. The blue dot is where you are at present, the place-marker with the green symbol is your starting point and the one with a black and white checkered symbol is your destination.

Search

Google Maps also serves well as an exploration tool. Use the Search option to type in the name of the place you want to look up, say a restaurant, multiplex, museum etc or simply press the Call button on your phone to search by voice and apart from giving you its address, it also provides you with relevant details like ratings and reviews on the place, listing info, services available, timings of shows and more rich details. You'll have handy options to



Find your location even without GPS



Mark your favourite place

directly call them up, visit their website or save the numbers as a contact on your phone. So next time before you are about to enter a new place to drink or dine, do a quick search on your phone and be better prepared for a good time.

Latitude

Stay connected at all times, click on Latitude in the Menu, sign into your account and activate this feature to see your friends on a map, find out who's nearby and meet up. It allows you share your location with whomever you choose till whatever level of detail you want. You can share, set or hide your location at any time and easily control which friends can track you.

Without GPS?

Even if your phone does not have GPS, you can still use Google Maps for Mobiles to tell your present location. The My Location feature is based on the BTS (Base Transceiver Station) of mobile operators with an accuracy of 1000 m approximately. Click on My Location in the Menu and a blue dot will slowly appear to mark your present location as accurately as possible but you'll need an active internet connection on the phone even if the data transfer is not very small, it is still a useful perk to have on your phone when travelling.

Make your own Maps

Click on My Maps > Create New Map and start making your own personal maps to which you can add text, images, drawings, and even videos and publish to anyone you'd like. Whether you are at home and giving directions to a friend or are a small business guiding people to your office, it's another fun feature you should explore on your phone. Depending on your location, you can create personalised, annotated and customised maps containing

place-markers, lines, shapes and then add useful web links or embed photos to add value. From the menu itself choose to make your Map public or accessible only through a unique URL for private use.

Favourite places

You can add a Star on locations you often visit and bookmark them for easy access or even new places you liked and want to note for the future. Just click on the Start icon next to the address and then next time using Menu you can easily open these Starred items and have a list of your favourite locations right in front of you, saving time and effort. If you use Google Maps on the web, you can quickly sign into your account from here and synchronize the starred items on your phone and on the net. Simply click on the Star next to the name in Starred Items to remove it from your list.

Reclaim the Forgotten Linux Empire

How to access your Linux box if you have forgotten all passwords!

The joy of Linux rests in its freedom. You can share it with your friends, distribute it and use it for what you want and dieu merci there is no one coming after for copyright violation. But just like any piece of software, it too has its own strengths and weaknesses. We will try to have a sneak peek into one of the problems (and of course its solution) which many users often face, some face occasionally and some might face it if they are too careful. The problem we are talking about is: forgetting your password for Linux Operating System.

It would be a real nightmare if your iPhone 4 you bought last month (and I assume you love it too much) gets a scratch on its cheek and that was a dejection capable enough to make you